Undo a release

> **Stage boundary, 5 November 2026:** finish local acceptance first; then prepare a separate approved source copy with fresh Git history and fully test it; then publish to a new client GitHub account for GitHub Pages remote acceptance; only after acceptance and an agreed cutover plan connect the IONOS domain. Existing `fleetmuckymayhem-dev` and Martin-account repositories/previews are rehearsals. Do not use repository renaming or a later ownership transfer as the handover route. See the current verification and acceptance checklist (final-local-acceptance.md). No push, merge, publishing/settings change, history removal or IONOS change is authorised in this local stage.

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> **Planned workflow, pending setup and rehearsal.** This page applies to the automated release process in Update, preview and publish (update-preview-publish.md).

Report problem → prepare and check undo PR → client approval → client merge → deployment → live verification.

Printable guide: the accompanying PDF is generated from this Markdown guide. Both describe the future process; neither authorises a release during local acceptance.

Your first step

Message us with the live page link, what is wrong, when you noticed it and a screenshot if useful. Include the release reference from our completion message. **Example:** “Since release #24, the ride link is wrong. Please undo that release.” A clear request to undo authorises that specific reversal. Otherwise, we confirm the proposed reversal with you first.

What we prepare and you publish

1. **Identify the cause.** We compare the live site with the last successful deployment. A failed build may mean the new version never published. Undoing code will not repair an unrelated DNS or hosting outage.
2. **Confirm the scope.** We identify the production release PR and explain what its reversal removes. Undoing a release can remove every change in it, including correct ones. We agree whether to undo it or make a small correction.
3. **Create the undo PR.** For the identified merged PR into `main`, we use GitHub's **Revert** action to propose the reversal. Creating this PR alone changes neither the live site nor `main`.
4. **You publish the undo.** We check the undo PR and send you its link. After the required checks and reviews pass, you merge it into `main`. The configured automation builds and publishes the reversed version. Tell us when you merge it.
5. **Verify and follow up.** We check the public website, send you the result and release reference, and reconcile `staging` with the reversal. Any corrected replacement goes through staging and your approval again.

If we are unavailable

The client account owner, or an authorised collaborator with write access, can follow the rehearsed procedure: **Pull requests**, **Closed**, open the exact production release PR, then **Revert**. Confirm the new PR targets `main` and reverses the intended release. Wait for checks and the required independent approval, then **Merge pull request** and **Confirm merge**. Keep branch protection in place. If Revert is unavailable, there are conflicts, or the scope is unclear, stop and contact technical support. GitHub describes these limitations in its revert guide.

Completion check

Confirm the production deployment succeeded and the expected content is back at **https://fleetmuckymayhem.com**. Record the undo PR/version and tell us so we can reconcile staging before the next release. Reversal preserves history. Do not delete branches, force-push, edit the generated staging repository or change IONOS DNS to undo an ordinary website update.